

NT 26 Enrichment:



†1. **Elder Russell M. Nelson:** “Olive trees are special in the Holy Land. The olive branch is universally regarded as a symbol of peace. This tree provides food, light, heat, lumber, ointments, and medicine. It is now, as it was then, crucial to life in Israel. It is not a deciduous tree, but everbearing—always green. Even if the tree is chopped down, life will spring from its roots, suggesting everlasting life. Jewish tradition often refers to the olive tree as the tree of life. To me it seems to prefigure the [Resurrection](#).”

Sites and Symbols of the Atonement

“Jesus came to the base of the Mount of Olives to effect the first component of the Atonement. This He did at the Garden of Gethsemane. The word Gethsemane comes from two Hebrew roots: gath, meaning “press,” and shemen, meaning “oil,” especially that of the olive.

“There olives had been pressed under the weight of great stone wheels to squeeze precious oil from the olives. So the Christ in the Garden of Gethsemane was literally pressed under the weight of the sins of the world. He sweated great drops of blood—his life’s “oil”—which issued from every pore.” (See [Luke 22:44](#); [D&C 19:18](#).) (“[Why This Holy Land?](#)” *Ensign*, Dec. 1989)

†2. **Alfred Edersheim:** “Properly understood, the Scripture is all full of Christ, and all intended to point to Christ as our only Saviour. It is not only the law, which is a schoolmaster unto Christ, nor the types, which are shadows of Christ, nor yet the prophecies, which are predictions of Christ. Even where persons are not, events may be types. If any one failed to see in Isaac or in Joseph a personal type of Christ, he could not deny that the offering up of Isaac, or the selling of Joseph, and his making provision for the sustenance of his brethren, are typical of events in the history of our Lord. And so indeed every event points to Christ, even as He is alike the beginning, the

centre, and the end of all history— ‘the same yesterday, and to-day, and for ever.’ One thing follows from this: only that reading or study of the Scriptures can be sufficient or profitable through which we learn to know Christ—and that as ‘the Way, the Truth, and the Life’ to us. And for this purpose we ought constantly to ask the aid and teaching of the Holy Spirit. ([Old Testament Bible History](#), 2-3; scroll down)

Recommended Reading:

1. Daniel Rona, “[NTGD Supplement #26](#),” at Hidden LDS / Jewish Insights.
2. Bill Beardall, “[New Testament Lesson 26](#).”
3. Ted L. Gibbons, “[Lesson #26 ‘To This End Was I Born](#).”
4. Nancy Jensen, “[New Testament Lesson #26](#),” at LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus, June 26, 2011.
5. Lenet H. Read, “[New Testament 26](#).”
6. [Messianic Prophecies](#) of Christ’s Crucifixion.
7. BYU Studies: “[To This End Was I Born](#)”.
8. Monte F. Shelley, “[NT 26: Gethsemane and Crucifixion](#),” 24 July 2011. This writing provides prophecies fulfilled by Christ’s crucifixion, Andrew Skinner’s story of “the distinctive red color” of the olive oil first out of the press. It quotes Brad Wilcox’s fine BYU talk on the Atonement on the second to the last page.
9. Gerald Smith, “[Lesson 26: ‘To This End Was I Born’](#),” Joel’s Monastery, June 23, 2011. This article provides a great summary of illegal procedures the Sanhedrin used to convict Christ of blasphemy.
10. Truman G. Madsen, “[The Olive Press](#),” *Ensign*, December 1982.

Recommended Media:

1. [The Crucifixion](#) (picture).
2. Lesson 25: New Testament Customs—[Olive Press](#) (0:50).
2. [Jesus Is Tried by Caiaphas, Peter Denies Knowing Him](#) (4:25).
3. [Jesus Is Condemned Before Pilate](#) (3:19).
4. [Jesus Is Scourged and Crucified](#) (4:49).
5. [To This End Was I Born](#) (16:00).